

Purpose

The aim of this policy is to give general guidance on the approved alcohol based and alcohol free disinfectant wipes products and methods for using it for healthcare equipment.

Scope

The policy will be utilized by all Healthcare Workers (HCWs), service department including housekeeping department.

Roles and Responsibilities

It is the responsibility of the ward or department in-charge to indent disinfectant wipes from the medical store as it is the hospital stock items. The in-charge should make sure the appropriate use of this wipes in their designated clinical areas.

Safety Notice

As safety measures; Alcohol free disinfectants wipes can cause moderate eye irritation, avoid contact with eyes or cloths. Wash with soap and water after handling and before eating or drinking.

The Alcohol based wipes can cause substantial but temporary eye irritation if incident occurs; hold eyes open and rinse slowly and gently with water for 10-20 minutes.

Instruction for usage

Currently, there are two types of disinfectant wipes used, the alcohol and alcohol free disposable wipes.

Alcohol-free wipes

(Currently in use PDI Sani-Cloth AF3, Bleach free, alcohol free)

- The active ingredient in the free alcohol wipes is Quaternary ammonium compounds, benzyl-C12-18-alkyldimethyl, which consider as disinfectant agent. Since they contain no alcohol, they are perfect for use on most thin plastics, electrical cords and other surfaces typically harmed by alcohol based products. This type can be used for hard, non-porous surfaces of:
 - telephones,
 - computer screen,
 - keyboards,
 - TV,
 - ultrasound probes and
 - Monitors attached to any electrical equipment.
- It should not be used on critical and semi critical medical devices.
- When handling items soiled with blood and body fluids use disposable latex gloves, gowns and masks. All blood and body fluids must be cleaned from the hard surfaces before application of the wipes
- To disinfect hard surfaces, thoroughly wet the surfaces to be treated. The treated surface must remain visibly wet and let air dry. Use additional wipes if needed to ensure that the treated surface remains continuously wet for the prescribed time.
- Contact time for a disinfectant is the amount of time a surface must remain wet with the product to achieve disinfection which is 10 minutes for all surfaces.

- Thus used wipes to clean blood and body fluids must be discarded in infectious waste disposal. This wipes are not for personal use or as a baby wipes. Do not flush in toilet.
- The wipes container's lid should be kept tightly closed between uses to retain moisture.

Alcohol wipes

(Currently in use MICRO PDI Sani-cloth Plus)

- The active ingredient of this type of wipes is alcohol.
- It may be use to pre-clean or decontaminate critical or semi-critical medical devices prior to sterilization or high level disinfection.
- This type can be used for hard, non-porous surfaces of which alcohol is compatible and instructed in the manufacturing labels.
- To use it during terminal cleaning after discharging patient of any type of isolation.
- It is not for use on the inhalation therapy or pulmonary diagnostic equipment.
- When handling items soiled with blood and body fluids use disposable latex gloves, gowns, masks and eye covering. All blood and body fluids must be cleaned from the hard surfaces before application of these wipes
- To disinfect hard surfaces, thoroughly wet the surfaces to be treated. The treated surface must remain visible wet and let air dry. Use additional wipes if needed to assure that the treated surface remains continuously wet for the prescribed time.
- Contact time for a disinfectant is the amount of time a surface must remain wet with the product to achieve disinfection which is 2 minutes.
- Do not use to clean walls, cupboards or doors or panels or office furniture
- Materials that may contain blood or body fluids should be disposed in clinical waste bag.
- Store the wipes canister in cool area, keep away from heat or open flame.
- do not get in eyes or cloth contact
- The wipes container's lid should be kept tightly closed between uses to retain moisture.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
Medline MICRO-KILL MSDS	Medline, USA	5/30/2015	1-6

Review / Revision History

Revision History			
Revision	Description of change		Revision Date
1	Initial Release	Mariam AL Hinnai	2016
2	Reviewed by	Dr. Zaina Al Maskari	2019
3	Reviewed by	Dr. Amal Al Tai	2021
4	Reviewed by	Ahlam Al Bulushi	2024
Written by Maryam Al Hinai	Checked by Ahlam Al Bulushi	Authorized by Dr. Amal Al Tai	